Resources

PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

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Textbooks

Open Educational Resources

I shall be providing sufficient reading materials to do well in class via the VLE, materials I have curated, remixed, or written myself - so that they are perfectly in line with the teaching on the course. However, if you like the smell of paper in the morning, you are welcome to consult any Psychology textbooks (most deal with the content we cover), but I highly recommend the 2 books below (free online via the Goldsmiths Library)

Recommended Texts (Available via Library)

Both textbooks are available as e-books through the Reading List on the VLE Goldsmiths Library (login required) :

- **Coolican, H. (2017).** ***Research methods and statistics in psychology*** **(6th Ed.). Hodder and Stoughton.** Coolican *Research methods and statistics in psychology*
- **Harris, P. (2008).** ***Designing and reporting experiments in psychology*** **(3rd Ed.). Open University Press.** Harris *Designing and reporting experiments in psychology*

> Accessing E-Books
>
> You'll need to log in with your Goldsmiths credentials. If you have trouble accessing, search via the Reading List or via the library.

Software

We will discuss the need for software LONG before it arises, but some students really enjoy this part of the course. If you happen to be one of this group, or part of the group that doesn't find it fun… We've got you! Don't worry!

WebR (In-Browser)

All lab activities use **WebR**—R that runs directly in your browser. You don't need to install anything.

R and RStudio (Optional)

If you want to install R on your own computer:

- Download R
- Download RStudio

Online Statistics Resources

Visual & Interactive

- Seeing Theory — Beautiful visual introduction to probability and statistics
- Statistics by Jim — Clear explanations of statistical concepts
- Stat Trek — Statistics tutorials and calculators

R resources for Psychology undergraduates

- Learning Statistics with R (Danielle Navarro)
  Probably the most psych-undergrad-friendly open textbook: concepts first, then R, with the usual psych stats sequence (t-tests, ANOVA, regression, etc.).

- R for Psychological Science (Danielle Navarro)
  More "learn R programming in a psych context" (great alongside a stats course).

- PsyTeachR: Data Skills for Reproducible Research (PsyTeachR team)
  A teachable, step-by-step route into tidyverse workflows and reproducible habits (projects, scripts, reporting), ideal for labs and dissertations.

Writing & APA Style

APA Format

- Purdue OWL APA Guide — Comprehensive APA formatting guide
- APA Style Website — Official APA resources

Academic Writing

- Goldsmiths Academic Skills — Writing support
- Phrasebank — Academic phrases and structures

Goldsmiths Resources

- Library — Books, journals, databases
- Academic Skills Centre — Study skills support
- Disability & Wellbeing — Support services
- IT Services — Technical support

Datasets

The main dataset for this module is generated in Week 11 (DataLab). Additional practice datasets will be provided for specific activities.

Dataset	Week	Description
DataLab	11	Class dataset used throughout term
EDS Practice	14+	Practice data for EDS preparation

Getting Help

Module Support

Resource	Details
Office Hours	Thursday 12:00-13:00
Email	g.wright@gold.ac.uk
VLE Discussion	For general questions (other students can help too)

Hypothes.is Annotation

This module uses **Hypothes.is** for collaborative annotation. Think of it as a shared highlighter and sticky-note system that lives on top of web pages. You can highlight passages, add comments and questions, and see what other students have noticed or wondered about.

Why use it?

- **Active reading** - Annotation helps you engage with material rather than passively skimming
- **Shared learning** - See what confuses or interests your classmates (you're probably not alone!)
- **Ask questions in context** - Flag something unclear right where it appears, rather than trying to describe it later
- **Build a revision resource** - Your annotations become a personalised study guide

Getting Started

1. **Create a free account** at hypothes.is
2. **Join our module group**: Foundations26
3. **Install the browser extension** or use the bookmarklet (instructions on the Hypothes.is site)
4. **Start annotating** - Look for the sidebar on course pages, or activate the extension on any web page

Private vs Group Annotations

When you annotate, you can choose to make your notes **private** (only you see them), share them with our **Foundations26 group** (classmates see them), or make them **public** (the whole internet). For this module, group annotations are most useful - but private notes work well for personal revision.